Comparing groups

REFERENCE SHEET

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Means 7

1. Math

Mean

$$\bar{y} = \frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^{n} y_i$$

$\bar{y}$ is the sample mean, which is calculated as the sum of all observations y_i divided by the number of observations (n).

Median

The median is determined by finding the middle value. If n is odd, the median is the middle value in the dataset. If n is even, the median is the mean of the two middle values.

Standard deviation

$$s = \sqrt{\frac{\sum(y_i - \bar{y})^2}{n-1}}$$

s is the sample standard deviation, which is calculated as the square root of the sum of the squared difference between an observation y_i and the sample mean $\bar{y}$ divided by the number of observations n minus 1.

Variance

$$s^2 = \frac{\sum(y_i - \bar{y})^2}{n-1}$$

Variance is calculated as the standard deviation squared. Note that the units of variance are the units squared (e.g. g^2, m^2, ppt^2).

2. Water quality

a. Calculating central tendency and spread

Site	Mean	Median	Standard deviation	Variance	Number of surveys
Phelps Bridge	3.7	2.2	5.3	27.9	234
East Channel	19.0	19.7	16.2	262.3	180
Venoco Bridge	22.7	23.4	18.3	336.0	242

b. Visualizing distributions

Purpose: represent the distribution of variable of interest

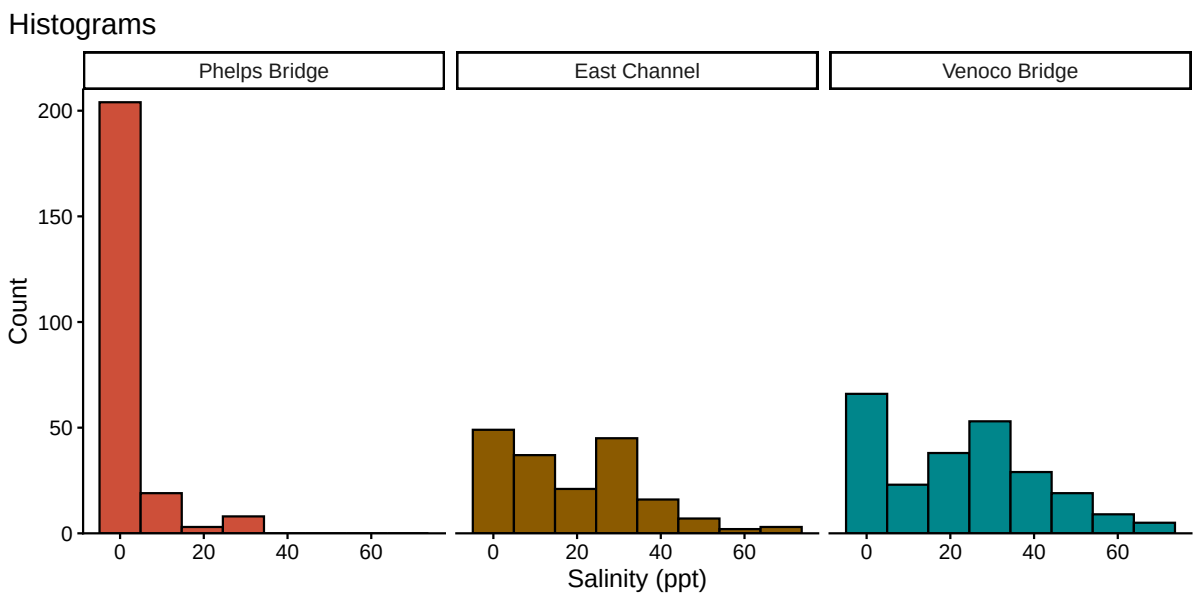
Histograms

Components

- x-axis: *continuous* variable of interest
- y-axis: counts
- Column height represents number of observations falling into a given bin range on the x-axis

Pay attention to:

- the shape of the distribution
- the center of the distribution
- the peak(s) of the distribution



Density plots

Components:

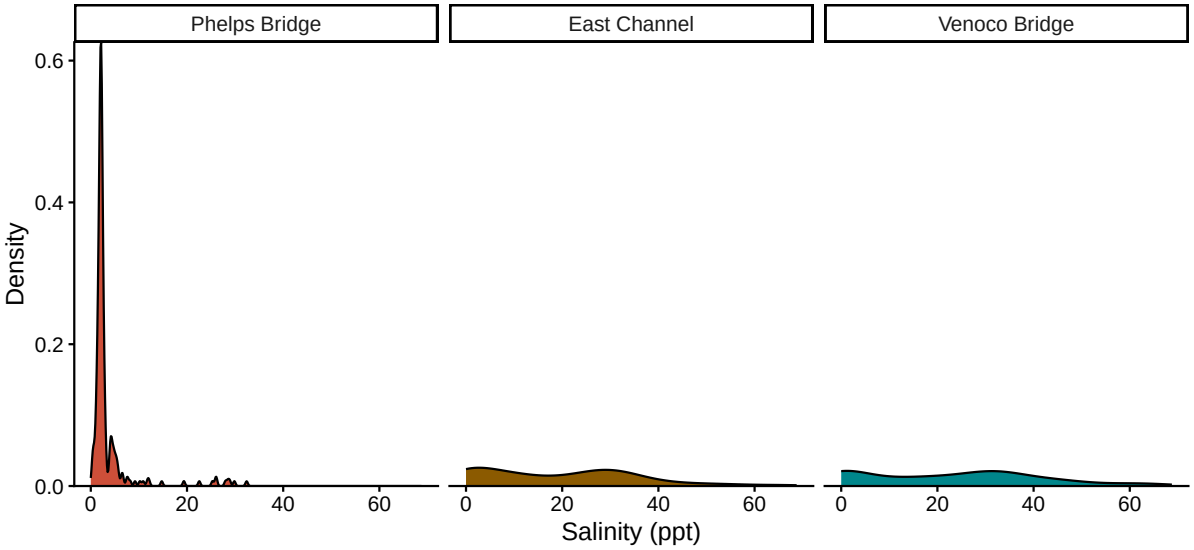
- x-axis: continuous variable of interest
- y-axis: probability density
- smoothed function representing the shape of the distribution
- note: area under that smoothed function = 1

Pay attention to:

- the shape of the **distribution**

- the center of the distribution
- the peak(s) of the distribution

Density plots



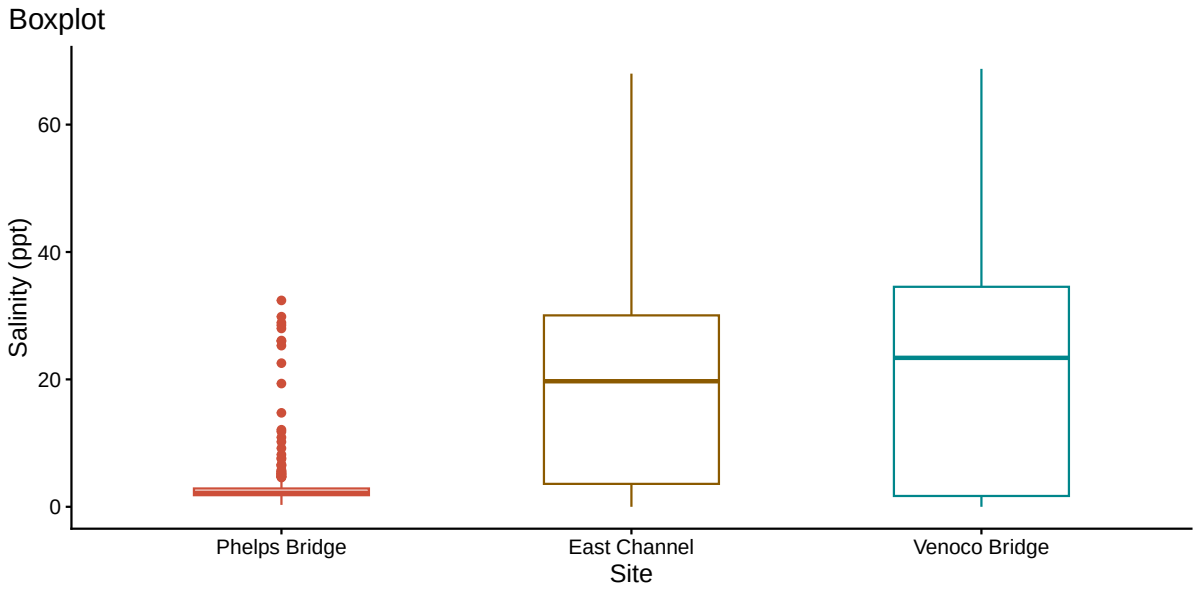
Interpretation:

Most salinity measurements from Phelps Bridge are low. Most salinity measurements from East Channel and Venoco Bridge are below 40 ppt.

Boxplots

Components:

- x-axis: categories (levels in a factor)
- y-axis: variable of interest
- middle line: median
- bottom of box: first quartile (25th percentile)
- top of box: third quartile (75th percentile)
- whiskers: 1.5 $\times$ interquartile range
- points: observation values outside 1.5 $\times$ interquartile range



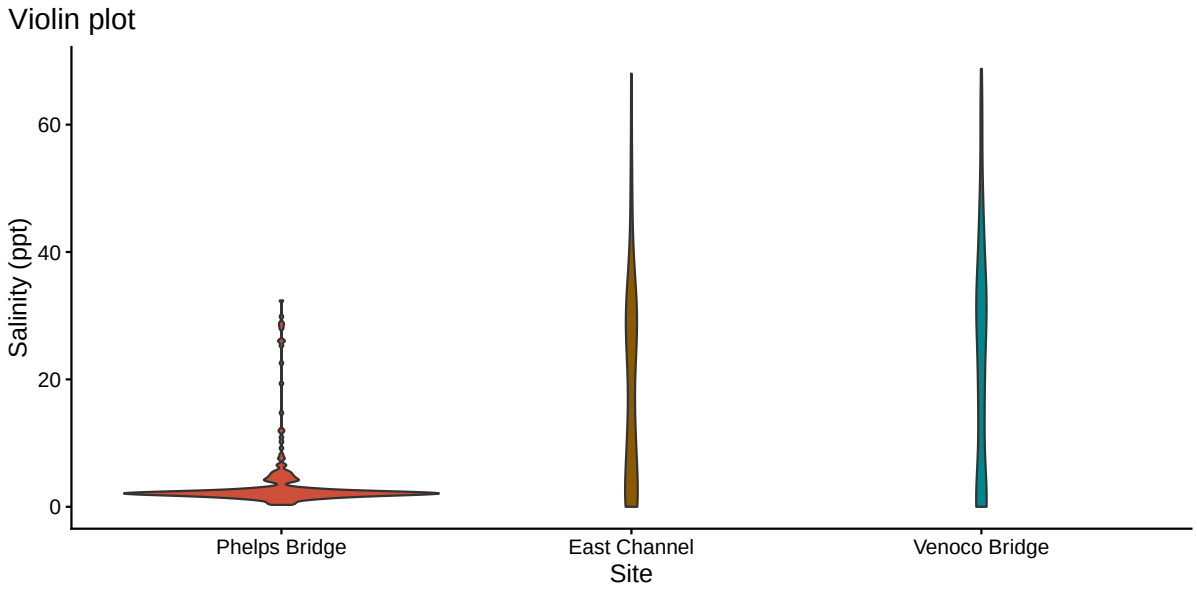
Violin charts

Components:

- x-axis: categories (levels in a factor)
- y-axis: variable of interest
- geometry: jittered points

Pay attention to:

- wide or narrow parts of the violin
- position of wide or narrow parts along y-axis



Strip charts

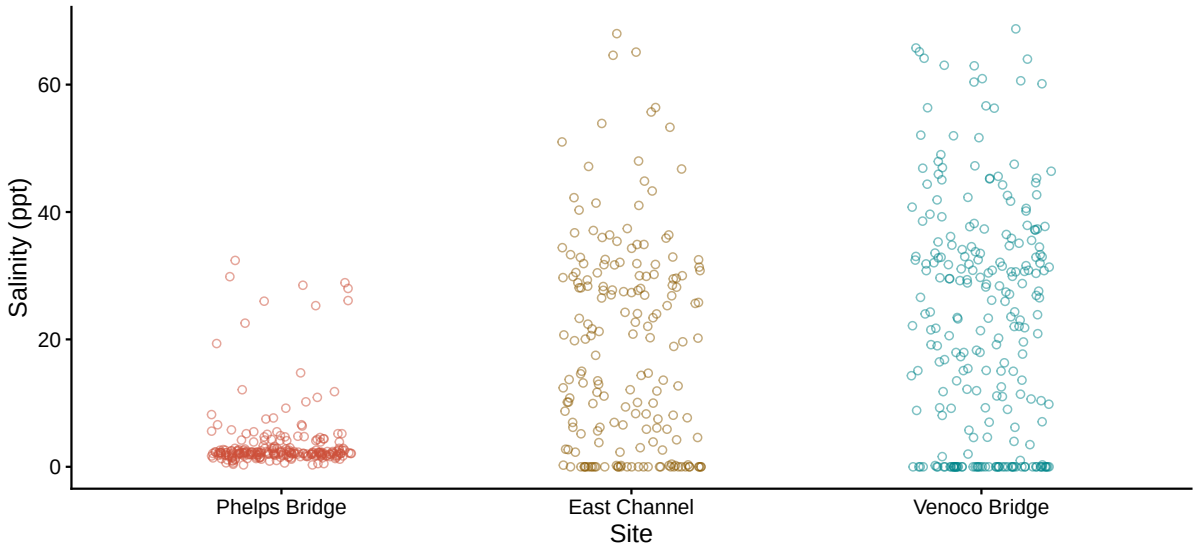
Components:

- x-axis: categories (levels in a factor)
- y-axis: variable of interest
- geometry: jittered points

Pay attention to:

- the clusters of points, if any
- position of points along the y-axis

Strip chart

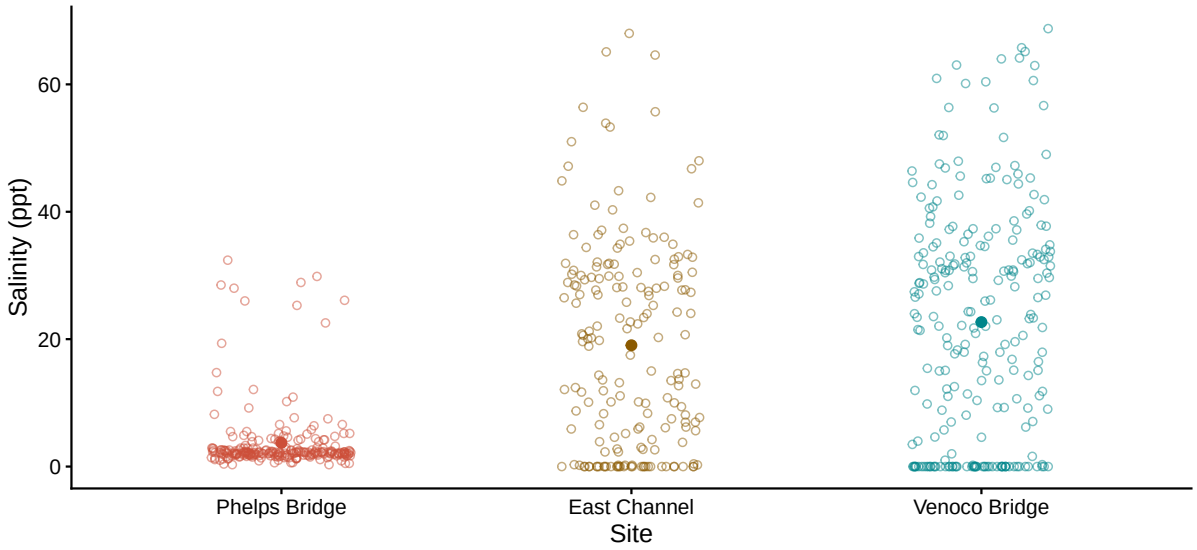


c. Visualizing central tendency and spread

Means

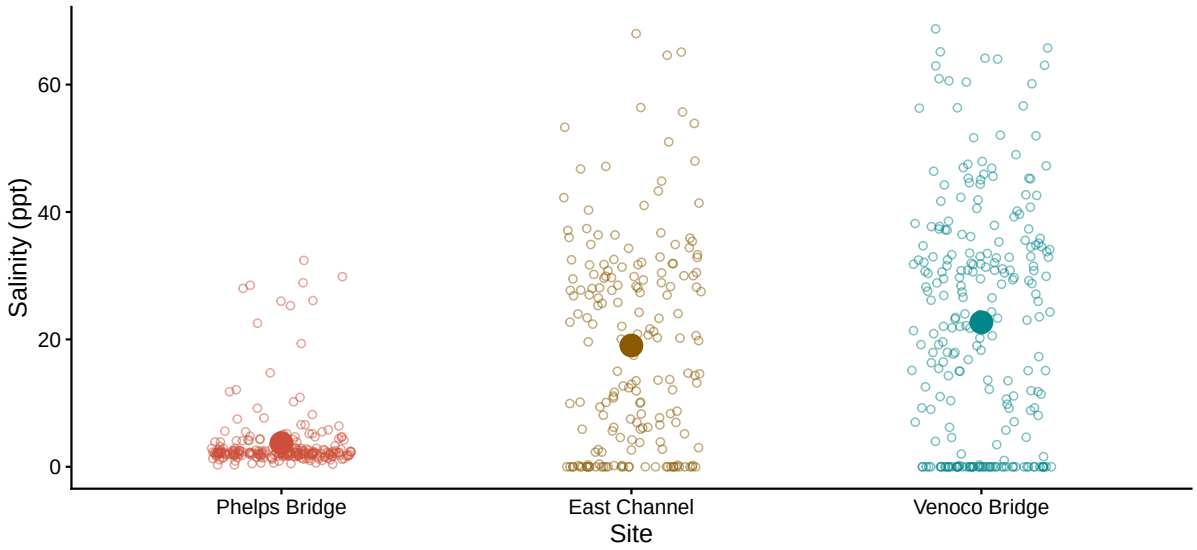
With standard deviation:

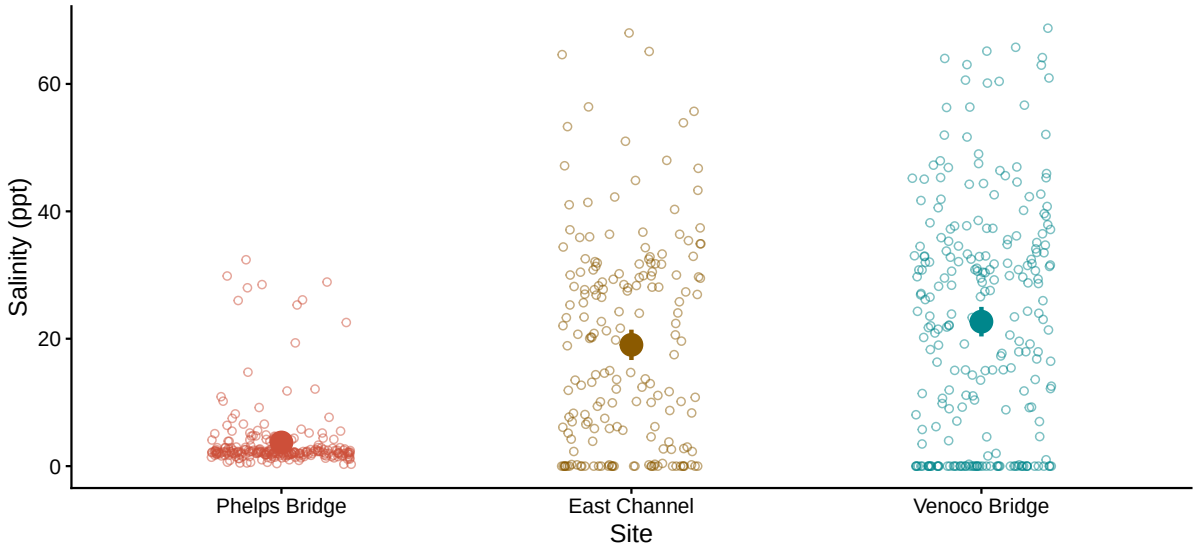
Strip chart with means



With standard error:

Strip chart with means and SE



With 95% confidence interval:

Strip chart with means and 95% confidence interval